NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1954–1960

Key Topic 1: The Development of the Civil Rights Movement, 1954–60

Segregation, Legal Challenges, School Desegregation & The Montgomery Bus Boycott



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • SEPTEMBER 1957

Soldiers of the 101st Airborne Escorting the Little Rock Nine, September 1957

Federal paratroopers of the 101st Airborne Division escort nine Black teenagers into Central High School, Little Rock, Arkansas, enforcing federal court desegregation orders against state resistance.

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 33 • KEY TOPIC 1 CONTENT — OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 The Position of Black Americans in the Early 1950s

- Segregation, discrimination and voting rights in the Southern states.
- The work of civil rights organisations, including the NAACP and CORE.

2 Developments in Education

- Reasons for, key features and significance of the Brown v. Topeka case (1954).
- Reasons for, key features and significance of the events at **Little Rock High School (1957)**.

3 The Montgomery Bus Boycott and Its Impact, 1955–60

- Causes and events of the **Montgomery Bus Boycott**. The significance of **Rosa Parks**.
- Reasons for the success and importance of the boycott. The Supreme Court ruling. The Civil Rights Act (1957).
- The significance of the leadership of **Martin Luther King**. The setting up of the **SCLC**.

4 Opposition to the Civil Rights Movement

- The Ku Klux Klan and violence, including the murder of Emmet Till in 1955.
- Opposition to desegregation in the South, including the 'Dixiecrats' and the setting up of White Citizens' Councils.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

17 May 1954 • Brown v. Board of Education Ruling

JUDICIAL PRECEDENT

The US Supreme Court unanimously rules (9–0) that state laws establishing separate public schools for Black and white students are unconstitutional, dismantling Plessy v. Ferguson.

28 August 1955 • Lynching of Emmett Till in Mississippi

CATALYST FOR ACTION

14-year-old Emmett Till is brutally murdered by white supremacists in Money, Mississippi. His mother's open-casket funeral in Chicago shocks the nation and galvanizes civil rights resistance.

1 December 1955 • Rosa Parks Arrest in Montgomery

GRASSROOTS TRIGGER

NAACP secretary Rosa Parks refuses to surrender her seat on a segregated Montgomery bus, prompting Jo Ann Robinson and the WPC to organize an immediate, community-wide bus boycott.

"Chronology is critical: Brown v. Board May 1954 before Montgomery Bus Boycott December 1955."

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

12 March 1956 • The Southern Manifesto Signed

MASSIVE RESISTANCE

101 Southern congressmen and senators sign the Declaration of Constitutional Principles, pledging to use all lawful means to resist federal school integration and preserve Jim Crow.

24 September 1957 • Eisenhower Sends 101st Airborne to Little Rock

FEDERAL ENFORCEMENT

President Eisenhower federalizes the Arkansas National Guard and deploys 1,000 paratroopers of the 101st Airborne Division to protect nine Black students entering Central High School.

9 September 1957 • Civil Rights Act of 1957 Enacted

FEDERAL STATUTE

The first federal civil rights legislation since Reconstruction establishes the Civil Rights Division in the Department of Justice and the US Commission on Civil Rights.

What was the position of Black Americans in the early 1950s?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the 1896 Plessy v. Ferguson ruling legally entrench racial segregation across the American South?

- Plessy v. Ferguson (1896)
- 'Separate but equal'
- Legal segregation basis

2 • In what ways did Jim Crow laws enforce daily economic, social, and physical subordination for Black Southern...

- Jim Crow statutes
- Segregated public facilities
- White supremacy codes

3 • Why did discriminatory voting restrictions leave Black Americans virtually powerless to challenge Southern se...

- Poll taxes enforced
- Literacy test hurdles
- Black disenfranchisement (<5%)

4 • How did the NAACP's legal strategy lay the groundwork for dismantling the 'separate but equal' doctrine in fede...

- NAACP legal fund
- Thurgood Marshall counsel
- Courtroom litigation strategy

5 • Why did early non-violent direct action by CORE mark an important tactical shift from courtroom litigation?

- CORE non-violent direct
- Journey of Reconciliation (1947)
- Gandhian protest tactics

"Brown v. Board: Earl Warren's unanimous 9–0 Supreme Court ruling that 'separate is inherently unequal'."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why it was difficult for Black Americans in the Southern states to exercise their civil rights in the early 1950s. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• Jim Crow laws and legal disenfranchisement	• The Ku Klux Klan (KKK) and white supremacist terror	***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 6)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.1). In the drawing box, sketch a segregated bus or municipal waiting room sign alongside the scales of justice to symbolize the Plessy v. Ferguson doctrine. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about legal segregation in the American South in the early 1950s. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Mississippi Department of Archives and History, State Statute Compendium*

The Mississippi State Code (§7785): All railroad companies and bus operators carrying passengers in this state shall provide equal but separate accommodations for the white and colored races by providing separate ca...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How did developments in education challenge segregation (1954–57)?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why was the 1954 Brown v. Board of Education decision a landmark turning point in the legal struggle against s...

- Brown v. Topeka (1954)
- Chief Justice Warren (9–0)
- Desegregation ordered 'all deliberate speed'

2 • How did Southern political leaders organize 'Massive Resistance' to block court-ordered school integration?

- 1956 Southern Manifesto
- Massive Resistance campaign
- Deep South non-compliance

3 • Why did Governor Orval Faubus deploy the Arkansas National Guard to surround Little Rock Central High Sch...

- Little Rock Central High
- Governor Orval Faubus
- National Guard blockade

4 • How did President Eisenhower's deployment of the 101st Airborne Division demonstrate federal supremacy ove...

- Eisenhower federalises troops
- 101st Airborne Division
- Armed student escorts

5 • What did the closure of Little Rock high schools during the 'Lost Year' reveal about the limits of initial desegreg...

- Little Rock high schools closed
- 'The Lost Year'
- Private white academies

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Supreme Court decision in Brown v. Board of Education (1954) was a turning point in the struggle for civil rights. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• The legal doctrine of 'separate but equal'	• The role of the NAACP and Thurgood Marshall	*(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 9)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.2). In the drawing box, sketch the 101st Airborne paratrooper escorting the Little Rock Nine past hostile crowds into Central High School. [ ] Done

"Montgomery Improvement Association: Domestic workers walked up to 12 miles a day to defeat bus segregation."

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the opposition faced by Black students attempting to desegregate Southern schools in 1957. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *United States Supreme Court, Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka, 347 U.S. 483 (1954)*

Does segregation of children in public schools solely on the basis of race, even though the physical facilities and other 'tangible' factors may be equal, deprive the children of the minority group of equal educatio...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How did the Montgomery Bus Boycott happen, and why did it succeed?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why was Rosa Parks' deliberate refusal to give up her seat the ideal catalyst to spark a citywide bus boycott?

- Rosa Parks arrest
- Montgomery NAACP secretary
- Women's Political Council flyers

2 • How did the formation of the Montgomery Improvement Association (MIA) unite the local Black community be...

- Montgomery Improvement Association
- Martin Luther King Jr.
- Non-violent boycott rally

3 • How did the community-run carpool network enable 50,000 citizens to sustain the boycott for over a year?

- 381-day sustained boycott
- Volunteer carpool network
- Bus company financial losses

4 • Why was the Browder v. Gayle Supreme Court ruling decisive in ending segregated public transit in Montgome...

- Browder v. Gayle (1956)
- Bus segregation unconstitutional
- 14th Amendment violation

5 • What was the broader national significance of the Montgomery Bus Boycott for the emerging civil rights move...

- Desegregated municipal buses
- SCLC foundation (1957)
- National direct-action catalyst

"Little Rock Nine (1957): Eisenhower deployed the 101st Airborne to enforce federal constitutional supremacy."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded in achieving its aims between 1955 and 1956. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- The Montgomery Improvement Association (MIA) and Martin Luther King Jr.
- The Supreme Court ruling in Browder v. Gayle (1956)

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 12)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.3). In the drawing box, sketch Rosa Parks on the Montgomery city bus alongside domestic workers walking on foot during the 381-day boycott. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the determination of the Black community during the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56). [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Montgomery Municipal Court Archives, Alabama Department of Archives and History*
Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Why did white people in the South resist integration, and how did they do it?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did White Citizens' Councils use economic intimidation and blacklisting to suppress Southern civil rights ...

- White Citizens' Councils
- Economic boycotts & firings
- Southern business intimidation

2 • Why did the brutal murder of 14-year-old Emmett Till shock international opinion and galvanize civil rights su...

- Emmett Till murder (1955)
- Open-casket funeral photos
- National outrage sparked

3 • What did the swift acquittal of Emmett Till's killers demonstrate about the Southern judicial system?

- Sumner Mississippi trial
- All-white jury acquittal
- Confessed killers protected

4 • How did violent KKK bombing campaigns against churches and homes paradoxically strengthen civil rights re...

- Ku Klux Klan resurgence
- Black church bombings
- Civil rights home attacks

5 • Why did the Civil Rights Act of 1957 fail to significantly expand Black voter registration across the Deep South?

- 1957 Civil Rights Act
- Strom Thurmond filibuster
- Weak voting enforcement

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why white segregationists mounted 'Massive Resistance' across the South between 1954 and 1960. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- White Citizens' Councils and economic intimidation
- The 'Southern Manifesto' and state governors

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 15)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 1.4). In the drawing box, sketch the Capitol dome with 101 Southern congressmen signing the Southern Manifesto alongside a White Citizens' Council placard. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the racial violence and terror inflicted on Black Americans in the South in 1955. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Special Collections, Mitchell Memorial Library, Mississippi State University*
Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)?

Target: AO3 [8 marks]: Analyse sources on Content, Contextual Knowledge, and Provenance (Nature, Origin, Purpose).

SOURCE B — Primary Evidence

"Another woman has been arrested and thrown into jail because she refused to get up out of her seat on the bus for a white person... This has to be stopped. Negroes have rights too. If Negroes did not ride the buses, they could not operate; three-fourths of the riders are Negroes. We are asking every Negro to stay off the buses on Monday in protest of the arrest and trial. Don't ride the buses to work, to town, to school, or anywhere on Monday. If you must work, take a cab, or share a ride, or walk."

Provenance: Protest leaflet written and mimeographed overnight by Jo Ann Robinson and the Women's Political Council (WPC), distributing 35,000 copies.

SOURCE C — Primary Evidence

"We are here this evening for serious business. We are here in a general sense because first and foremost we are American citizens, and we are determined to apply our citizenship to the fullness of its meaning... There comes a time when people get tired of being trampled over by the iron feet of oppression. Our method will be that of persuasion, not coercion. We will say to the people: let your conscience be your guide. Our actions must be guided by the highest Christian principles of love and non-violence."

Provenance: Speech delivered by Dr Martin Luther King Jr. at Holt Street Baptist Church to over 5,000 citizens at the first mass rally of the boycott.

SOURCE B UTILITY (CONTENT & COP): SHOWS THE IMMEDIATE GRASSROOTS MOBILIZATION, THE ROLE OF JO ANN ROBINSON/WPC, AND THE DELIBERATE STRATEGY OF ECONOMIC PRESSURE (75% BLACK PASSENGERS). *(Analyse Content, Historical Context & Provenance NOP)*

Score: [/ 8]

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 & 2

Study Interpretations 1 and 2 below for Questions 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)

INTERPRETATION 1

"The Montgomery Bus Boycott was fundamentally the achievement of organized Black working-class women. Long before national male leaders arrived, Jo Ann Robinson and the Women's Political Council had methodically planned a bus strike. Within hours of Rosa Parks' arrest, Robinson spent the night mimeographing 35,000 leaflets. Over the next 381 days, thousands of domestic maids and cooks walked up to twelve miles a day in freezing winter and blistering summer, while local drivers ran an intricate 300-car dispatch network. It was this daily grassroots courage and economic sacrifice—depriving the bus company of over 70% of its passengers—that brought Montgomery to its knees."

Historian Danielle L. McGuire, 'At the Dark End of the Street: Black Women, Rape, and Resistance' (2010)

INTERPRETATION 2

"While grassroots logistics sustained the boycott, the movement achieved national momentum and ultimate victory because of the charismatic moral leadership of Dr Martin Luther King Jr. King provided the strategic vision and rhetorical genius that unified disparate local factions and prevented violent retaliation despite firebombings and arrests. He framed the local dispute as a national crusade for Christian justice, attracting essential northern financial support and national media coverage. Crucially, local economic pressure alone could not change municipal segregation laws; success ultimately depended on the legal strategy that secured the Supreme Court's Browder v. Gayle ruling."

Historian David L. Lewis, 'King: A Critical Biography' (1970)

Question 3(b): Main Difference in Views [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main reason why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations.

Formula: Interpretation 1 argues that the boycott succeeded primarily due to grassroots mobilization and economic sacrifices of working-class Black women (Jo Ann Robinson, WPC, walking domestic workers), whereas Interpretation 2 argues that success was primarily driven by Dr Martin Luther King Jr.'s charismatic moral leadership and federal legal intervention (Browder v. Gayle).

Question 3(c): Reason Why Interpretations Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the main reason why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

Examiner Guidance: The historians give different views because they have relied on different types of primary evidence. The author of Interpretation 1 has focused on grassroots evidence such as Source B, highlighting the practical organizational labor of the Women's Political Council and economic leverage. In contrast, the author of Interpretation 2 has drawn upon evidence such as Source C, emphasizing Dr King's philosophical oratory and national leadership.

QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)?

Thesis Prompt: Establish your judgment criteria, select quotes from Interpretations 1 & 2, and deploy contextual historical knowledge.

Criteria Planning Canvas: Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict: *(Essay continues on Page 19)*

Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks): Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment. **SPaG: 4/4 MARKS**

Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

AO4: [/ 16] | SPaG: [/ 4] | Total: [/ 20]

[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)?

Write your response in the space provided below:

Band 4 Criteria Check:	[ ] Criteria Established	[ ] Both Ints Explored	[ ] Precise Own Knowledge	[ ] Justified Verdict	**Teacher Sign-off:** _____

"Question 3(d): Build a criteria-led sustained judgment; weigh both interpretations with precise own knowledge." **19/20**

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 1 TRACKER

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–1975 (The Development of the Civil Rights Movement, 1954–60)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 INFER (4M)	Q2 EXPLAIN (12M)	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT1.1: What was the position of Black Americans in the early 1950s?** *"What was the position of Black Americans in the early 1950s?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
2	**KT1.2: How did developments in education challenge segregation (1954–57)?** *"How did developments in education challenge segregation (1954–57)?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
3	**KT1.3: How did the Montgomery Bus Boycott happen, and why did it succeed?** *"How did the Montgomery Bus Boycott happen, and why did it succeed?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
4	**KT1.4: Why did white people in the South resist integration, and how did they do it?** *"Why did white people in the South resist integration, and how did they do it?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
★	**Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)** *Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]*	Q3(a): / 8	Q3(b): / 4	Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20	/ 36
KEY TOPIC 1 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1 Infer: / 16**	**Q2 Cause: / 48**	**/ 140**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • 20-QUESTION PRACTICE QUIZZES

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes

KT 1.1	KT 1.2	KT 1.3	KT 1.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 2 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1960–1975

Key Topic 2: The Protest Movement and Civil Rights Resurgence, 1960–75

Sit-Ins, Freedom Rides, Birmingham, Selma, The Civil Rights Acts & Black Power



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • 28 AUGUST 1963

Mass Civil Rights Assembly at the Lincoln Memorial, 28 August 1963

Over 250,000 civil rights demonstrators surround the Reflecting Pool in Washington, D.C., during the historic March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom where Dr King delivered his 'I Have a Dream' address.

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 33 • KEY TOPIC 2 CONTENT OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 Developments, 1960–62

- The significance of Greensboro and the sit-in movement.
- Reasons for, key features and significance of the **Freedom Riders**, including Ku Klux Klan violence and the Anniston bomb (1961).
- The James Meredith case (1962).

2 Peaceful Protests and Their Impact, 1963–65

- King and the peace marches of 1963 in Birmingham and Washington.
- Freedom Summer and the Mississippi murders.
- The impact of peaceful protest and the roles of Presidents Kennedy and Johnson in the passage of the **Civil Rights Act (1964)**. Selma and the **Voting Rights Act (1965)**.

3 Malcolm X and Black Power, 1963–70

- **Malcolm X**, his beliefs, methods and involvement with the Black Muslims. His later change of attitude and assassination.
- Reasons for the emergence of **Black Power**. The significance of Stokely Carmichael and the 1968 Mexico Olympics.
- The methods and achievements of the Black Panther movement.

4 The Civil Rights Movement, 1965–75

- The riots of 1965–67 and the Kerner Report (1968).
- King's campaign in the North. The assassination of **Martin Luther King** and its impact.
- The extent of progress in civil rights by 1975.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

1 February 1960 • Greensboro Lunch Counter Sit-Ins

DIRECT ACTION

Four Black freshmen at North Carolina A&T sit at a segregated Woolworth's lunch counter in Greensboro, launching a nationwide wave of student sit-ins that integrated over 100 municipal venues.

4 May 1961 • CORE Freedom Rides Depart Washington

INTERSTATE TRANSIT

Interracial activists board commercial buses heading into the Deep South to test federal bans on terminal segregation, facing horrific KKK bombings in Anniston and mob violence in Birmingham.

2–7 May 1963 • Birmingham Children's Crusade

MEDIA TURNING POINT

Police Commissioner Bull Connor deploys high-pressure firehoses and police attack dogs against student marchers in Birmingham, Alabama, provoking international outrage.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

28 August 1963 • March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom

NATIONAL MOBILIZATION

250,000 citizens march peacefully on the National Mall, uniting the 'Big Six' civil rights groups and creating overwhelming political momentum for comprehensive federal legislation.

2 July 1964 • Civil Rights Act of 1964 Signed

LEGISLATIVE LANDMARK

President Johnson signs the landmark statute prohibiting racial segregation in all public accommodations, banning employment discrimination, and creating the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission.

6 August 1965 • Voting Rights Act of 1965 Enacted

DEMOCRACY RESTORED

Following the brutal police beatings of marchers on 'Bloody Sunday' in Selma, Alabama, LBJ outlaws literacy tests and authorizes federal registrars, transforming Southern elections.

How did peaceful protests (like sit-ins and Freedom Rides) force the government to act?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the Greensboro lunch counter sit-ins spark a spontaneous, youth-led wave of direct action across the S...

- Greensboro lunch-counter sit-in
- Woolworth four students
- Non-violent youth wave

2 • Why was the creation of SNCC critical in mobilizing young students into the front line of civil rights protest?

- Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee
- Ella Baker leadership
- Grassroots student mobilization

3 • What was the primary goal of the 1961 Freedom Rides organized by CORE across the interstate South?

- CORE Freedom Rides (1961)
- Interstate bus integration
- Testing Boynton v. Virginia

4 • How did televised violence against Freedom Riders in Anniston and Montgomery force federal intervention?

- Anniston bus firebombing
- Montgomery mob beatings
- Televised brutality shock

5 • Why did the ICC's November 1961 desegregation order represent a decisive victory for direct action protest?

- Attorney General Robert Kennedy
- ICC desegregation enforcement
- Interstate terminal victory

"Freedom Rides (May 1961): CORE activists firebombed in Anniston; RFK ordered federal marshals to Alabama."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why peaceful direct action (sit-ins and Freedom Rides) succeeded in desegregating public facilities between 1960 and 1961. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:	• The Greensboro sit-ins and the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC)	• The Freedom Rides and the Interstate Commerce Commission (ICC)	***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 6)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 2.1). In the drawing box, sketch the Greensboro Four sitting peacefully at the Woolworth's lunch counter amidst angry white onlookers. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the discipline of civil rights demonstrators during the lunch counter sit-ins (1960). [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Associated Press Archive, Newsfilm and Still Photography Collection*

Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How did protests in Birmingham and Selma lead to the Civil and Voting Rights Acts?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did Bull Connor's violent suppression of the Children's Crusade in Birmingham transform national opinio...

- Project 'C' Birmingham (1963)
- Chief Bull Connor
- Police dogs & firehoses

2 • Why was the 1963 March on Washington a pivotal moment in generating momentum for federal civil rights laws?

- March on Washington (1963)
- 250,000 peaceful marchers
- 'I Have a Dream'

3 • How did the Civil Rights Act of 1964 dismantle the legal foundations of Southern Jim Crow segregation?

- Civil Rights Act (1964)
- President Lyndon Johnson
- Public segregation banned

4 • Why did the violent clash on Edmund Pettus Bridge in Selma create irresistible momentum for federal voting ri...

- Selma voting campaign (1965)
- Edmund Pettus Bridge
- 'Bloody Sunday' tear-gas

5 • In what ways did the Voting Rights Act of 1965 revolutionize political participation for Black Americans in the S...

- Voting Rights Act (1965)
- Literacy tests abolished
- Federal voting registrars

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Civil Rights Act was passed in 1964. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Birmingham Campaign (May 1963) • The assassination of President John F. Kennedy (November 1963) *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 9)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 2.2). In the drawing box, sketch the Edmund Pettus Bridge in Selma alongside Dr King delivering his address before the Lincoln Memorial. [ ] Done

"March on Washington (August 1963): 250,000 citizens gathered at the Lincoln Memorial for jobs and freedom."

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the message and impact of the 1963 March on Washington. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Dr Martin Luther King Jr., Letter from Birmingham Jail (16 April 1963)*

We know through painful experience that freedom is never voluntarily given by the oppressor; it must be demanded by the oppressed. Frankly, I have yet to engage in a direct action campaign that was 'well timed' in t...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

What was the Black Power movement, and how did it differ from non-violent protests?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did Malcolm X reject non-violent integrationism in favor of Black nationalism and self-defense?

- Malcolm X ministry
- Nation of Islam separatism
- 'By any means necessary'

2 • How did Stokely Carmichael's call for 'Black Power' during the 1966 Meredith March divide the civil rights mov...

- Stokely Carmichael (SNCC)
- 1966 March Against Fear
- 'Black Power' slogan

3 • What were the primary aims and methods outlined in the Black Panther Party's Ten-Point Program?

- Huey Newton & Bobby Seale
- Black Panther Party
- Ten-Point Program armed-patrols

4 • How did the Panthers' community survival programs challenge mainstream media portrayals of the party as m...

- Free Breakfast for Children
- Community medical clinics
- FBI COINTELPRO targeting

5 • Why was the silent protest by Tommie Smith and John Carlos at the 1968 Olympics such a powerful cultural stat...

- 1968 Mexico Olympics
- Tommie Smith & John Carlos
- Black-gloved podium salute

"Mississippi Freedom Summer (1964): Chaney, Goodman, and Schwerner murdered by the KKK for registering Black voters."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Voting Rights Act was passed in 1965. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Selma to Montgomery marches and 'Bloody Sunday' (March 1965) • The Mississippi Freedom Summer and the murder of civil rights workers (1964) ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 12)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 2.3). In the drawing box, sketch the raised clenched-fist salute of Tommie Smith and John Carlos at the 1968 Mexico City Olympic Games. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the Black Power salute at the 1968 Mexico City Olympic Games. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture, New York Public Library*

Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Why did riots break out in American cities between 1965 and 1968?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did a routine traffic arrest in Watts ignite six days of violent urban rebellion in August 1965?

- Watts riot Los Angeles (1965)
- Police brutality catalyst
- 34 dead & $40m damage

2 • What did Dr King's campaign in Chicago reveal about the entrenched nature of northern de facto segregation?

- Chicago Freedom Movement (1966)
- Slum housing & redlining protest
- Marquette Park violent backlash

3 • How did the violent urban rebellions in Newark and Detroit in 1967 demonstrate the failure of Great Society ant...

- Detroit & Newark riots (1967)
- 43 dead in Detroit violence
- Federal airborne paratroopers

4 • Why did the Kerner Commission Report conclude that white racism was the primary cause of urban riots?

- 1968 Kerner Commission report
- 'Two societies: separate, unequal'
- White institutional racism blamed

5 • How did the assassination of Dr Martin Luther King Jr. and the passage of the 1968 Fair Housing Act reshape th...

- King assassinated in Memphis
- Nationwide 100-city uprisings
- 1968 Fair Housing Act passed

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Black Power movement grew in popularity in the late 1960s. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- The ideas of Malcolm X and the Black Panther Party
- Frustration with the limitations of non-violent civil rights laws in northern cities

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 15)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 2.4). In the drawing box, sketch smoke billowing from the Detroit riots of 1967 alongside the Kerner Commission Report on urban segregation. [ ] Done

"Black Power (1966): Stokely Carmichael rejected interracial non-violence in favour of Black economic and political control."

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the causes of urban riots in American cities between 1965 and 1968. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Statement of Tommy Jacquette, Watts Community Organizer, Los Angeles (August 1965)*

Since August 1965, where are we going? Where is Watts going? We didn't burn our own community; we burned the property of white slumlords and merchants who bled our people dry for generations. It was a revolt, not a ...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the causes of the riots in northern and western cities between 1965 and 1967?

Target: AO3 [8 marks]: Analyse sources on Content, Contextual Knowledge, and Provenance (Nature, Origin, Purpose).

SOURCE B — Primary Evidence

"Our nation is moving toward two societies, one black, one white—separate and unequal... Segregation and poverty have created in the racial ghetto a destructive environment totally unknown to white Americans. What white Americans have never fully understood—but what the Negro can never forget—is that white society is deeply implicated in the ghetto. White institutions created it, white institutions maintain it, and white society condones it. Pervasive discrimination in employment and housing, coupled with routine police harassment, has generated a reservoir of frustration that ignited in Watts, Newark, and Detroit."

Provenance: From the official findings of the National Advisory Commission on Civil Disorders (the Kerner Commission), established by President Lyndon B. Johnson to investigate urban riots.

SOURCE C — Primary Evidence

"We have been begging the white man for freedom for over a century, singing 'We Shall Overcome' while his police beat our heads and his judges throw us in jail. Non-violence has failed to protect Black people in the northern slums. The Civil Rights Act did not give our brothers jobs; it did not tear down the rats and roaches in Harlem and Chicago! Black Power means Black people coming together to organize our own strength. If white police come into our communities acting like an occupying army, Black men have a duty to defend themselves and take control of our own destiny."

Provenance: Speech by SNCC leader Stokely Carmichael delivered to an audience of urban Black youths in Chicago, widely broadcast across national media.

SOURCE B UTILITY (CONTENT & COP): OFFICIAL GOVERNMENT INVESTIGATION IDENTIFYING DEEP STRUCTURAL CAUSES: WHITE RACISM, GHETTOIZATION, HOUSING REDLINING, 30% UNEMPLOYMENT, AND POLICE HOSTILITY. *(Analyse Content, Historical Context & Provenance NOP)*

SOURCE C UTILITY (CONTENT & COP): EYEWITNESS POLITICAL SPEECH DEMONSTRATING THE IDEOLOGICAL SHIFT TOWARDS BLACK POWER, DISILLUSIONMENT WITH NON-VIOLENCE, AND ACTIVE ANGER AGAINST WHITE POLICE BRUTALITY. **Score: [/ 8]**

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 & 2

Study Interpretations 1 and 2 below for Questions 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)

INTERPRETATION 1

"The explosion of urban rebellions in Watts, Chicago, Newark, and Detroit was the direct consequence of intolerable economic despair and de facto segregation in northern ghettos. While the civil rights movement had won voting rights in the South, it had done almost nothing to alleviate poverty, dilapidated tenement housing, and 30% youth unemployment in northern cities. Confined by bank redlining and landlord discrimination into overcrowded slums, and subjected to routine brutality by almost entirely white police forces, young Black urbanites felt completely excluded from American prosperity. The riots were spontaneous eruptions of economic rage against living conditions that legislative civil rights acts had left untouched."

Historian Harvard Sitkoff, 'The Struggle for Black Equality, 1954–1980' (1981)

INTERPRETATION 2

"The wave of urban violence from 1965 onwards was driven primarily by a profound ideological transformation: the rise of Black Power and militant Black nationalism. Inspired by the uncompromising rhetoric of Malcolm X and popularized by Stokely Carmichael, younger activists completely rejected Martin Luther King's philosophy of non-violence and interracial integration. Black Power taught urban youth that non-violence was humiliating and ineffective, encouraging them instead to confront white institutional power directly. The fiery speeches of SNCC and Black Panther leaders gave voice and political legitimacy to rebellion, transforming street unrest into conscious acts of defiance against white authority."

Historian Clayborne Carson, 'In Struggle: SNCC and the Black Awakening of the 1960s' (1981)

Question 3(b): Main Difference in Views [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main cause of the urban riots between 1965 and 1967. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations.

Formula: Interpretation 1 argues that the urban riots were spontaneous eruptions driven by severe economic deprivation, poverty, and de facto ghetto segregation in northern cities, whereas Interpretation 2 argues that the riots were primarily caused by an ideological shift towards Black Power, Malcolm X's rhetoric, and the rejection of non-violence.

Question 3(c): Reason Why Interpretations Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the main cause of the urban riots between 1965 and 1967. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

Examiner Guidance: The historians have different views because they have relied on different historical evidence. The author of Interpretation 1 has focused on socio-economic investigations such as the Kerner Commission Report in Source B, which emphasized structural poverty and housing discrimination. In contrast, the author of Interpretation 2 has examined political speeches and activist manifestos such as Source C, emphasizing the radical rhetoric of Stokely Carmichael and the appeal of Black Power.

QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the causes of the riots in northern and western cities between 1965 and 1967?

Thesis Prompt: Establish your judgment criteria, select quotes from Interpretations 1 & 2, and deploy contextual historical knowledge.

Criteria Planning Canvas: Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict: *(Essay continues on Page 19)*

Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks): Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment. **SPaG: 4/4 MARKS**

Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

AO4: [/ 16] | SPaG: [/ 4] | Total: [/ 20]

[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the causes of the riots in northern and western cities between 1965 and 1967?

Write your response in the space provided below:

Band 4 Criteria Check:	[ ] Criteria Established	[ ] Both Ints Explored	[ ] Precise Own Knowledge	[ ] Justified Verdict	**Teacher Sign-off:** _____

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 2 TRACKER

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–1975 (The Protest Movement and Civil Rights Resurgence, 1960–75)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 INFER (4M)	Q2 EXPLAIN (12M)	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT2.1: How did peaceful protests (like sit-ins and Freedom Rides) force the government to act?** *"How did peaceful protests (like sit-ins and Freedom Rides) force the government to act?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
2	**KT2.2: How did protests in Birmingham and Selma lead to the Civil and Voting Rights Acts?** *"How did protests in Birmingham and Selma lead to the Civil and Voting Rights Acts?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
3	**KT2.3: What was the Black Power movement, and how did it differ from non-violent protests?** *"What was the Black Power movement, and how did it differ from non-violent protests?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
4	**KT2.4: Why did riots break out in American cities between 1965 and 1968?** *"Why did riots break out in American cities between 1965 and 1968?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
★	**Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)** *Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]*	Q3(a): / 8	Q3(b): / 4	Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20	/ 36
KEY TOPIC 2 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1 Infer: / 16**	**Q2 Cause: / 48**	**/ 140**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • 20-QUESTION PRACTICE QUIZZES

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes

KT 2.1	KT 2.2	KT 2.3	KT 2.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**

"Question 3(d): Deliver a criteria-driven verdict on whether police violence or economic deprivation was the primary catalyst."

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 3 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1954–1968

Key Topic 3: US Involvement in the Vietnam War, 1954–68

Domino Theory, Diem Regime, Gulf of Tonkin, Rolling Thunder & The Tet Offensive



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • 1966

US Army "Huey" Combat Assault Landing in South Vietnam, 1966

Bell UH-1D Iroquois helicopters land US infantry into a forward jungle clearing, demonstrating the air mobility and search-and-destroy doctrine central to General Westmoreland's strategy.

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 33 • KEY TOPIC 3 CONTENT OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 Reasons for US Involvement in the Conflict in Vietnam, 1954–63

- Reasons for greater US involvement under Eisenhower, including the **domino theory** and weaknesses of the Diem government.
- Greater involvement under Kennedy, including the overthrow of Diem and the Strategic Hamlet Program.

2 Escalation of the Conflict Under Johnson

- Reasons for the escalation of the conflict and increased US involvement in Vietnam, including the increasing threat of the Vietcong and the **Gulf of Tonkin** incident (1964).

3 The Nature of the Conflict in Vietnam, 1964–68

- The guerrilla tactics used by the Vietcong.
- The methods used by the USA, including **Search and Destroy**, **Operation Rolling Thunder** and chemical weapons.
- The key features and significance of the Tet Offensive, 1968.

4 Changes Under Nixon, 1969–73

- The key features of **Vietnamisation**. Reasons for its failure.
- The Nixon Doctrine and the withdrawal of US troops.
- Attacks on Cambodia (1970) and Laos (1971), and the bombing of North Vietnam (1972).

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

21 July 1954 • Geneva Accords Partition Vietnam

COLD WAR BORDER

Following the French defeat at Dien Bien Phu, international agreements divide Vietnam at the 17th parallel pending nationwide democratic elections scheduled for 1956.

1 November 1963 • Assassination of Ngo Dinh Diem

REGIME COLLAPSE

Following widespread Buddhist protests and international revulsion at self-immolations, South Vietnamese military generals overthrow and assassinate Catholic dictator Ngo Dinh Diem.

7 August 1964 • Gulf of Tonkin Resolution Passed

EXECUTIVE BLANK CHEQUE

Following alleged North Vietnamese torpedo attacks on the USS Maddox, Congress passes the resolution empowering President Johnson to take all necessary steps to defend South Vietnam.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

8 March 1965 • US Combat Marines Land at Da Nang

DIRECT INTERVENTION

3,500 US Marines land on Red Beach Two at Da Nang to protect the American airbase, marking the transition from military advisers to direct ground combat operations.

14–18 November 1965 • Battle of the Ia Drang Valley

CONVENTIONAL CLASH

The 1st Cavalry Division engages North Vietnamese regulars in the first major conventional battle, confirming the lethality of helicopter airmobile tactics and dense jungle ambush.

30–31 January 1968 • The Tet Offensive Launched

STRATEGIC TURNING POINT

84,000 Vietcong and North Vietnamese soldiers breach the US Embassy in Saigon and strike 100 cities, shattering General Westmoreland's claims that the war was nearly won.

Why did the US support the unpopular government of Ngo Dinh Diem in South Vietnam?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did the French defeat at Dien Bien Phu lead to the temporary partition of Vietnam at the 17th Parallel?

- Battle of Dien Bien Phu
- French colonial collapse
- 17th parallel partition

2 • Why did Ngo Dinh Diem cancel the 1956 nationwide reunification elections with American support?

- President Dwight Eisenhower
- Domino theory concept
- SEATO alliance formed

3 • How did Diem's repressive policies in South Vietnam lead directly to the formation of the Vietcong in 1960?

- Ngo Dinh Diem regime
- Refusal of nationwide elections
- Strategic hamlets resentment

4 • Why did the Strategic Hamlet Program and the Buddhist Crisis fatally undermine South Vietnamese support fo...

- President John F. Kennedy
- Green Beret advisers (16,000)
- Buddhist monk self-immolations

5 • How did the 1963 military coup and assassination of Diem leave the United States trapped in South Vietnam?

- South Vietnamese military coup
- Diem assassinated (Nov 1963)
- Saigon political instability

"Ngo Dinh Diem: US-backed Catholic dictator in Saigon who cancelled elections and brutally repressed the Buddhist majority."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the United States became increasingly involved in Vietnam between 1954 and 1963. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Domino Theory and the Cold War containment policy • US support for Ngo Dinh Diem and the growth of the Vietcong *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on Page 6)*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.1). In the drawing box, sketch falling dominoes marked Vietnam, Laos, and Cambodia alongside a map of the 17th parallel partition line. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about American geopolitical fears regarding the spread of communism in Southeast Asia (1954). [4 marks]

SOURCE A *President Dwight D. Eisenhower, The President's News Conference (7 April 1954), Public Papers of the Presidents*

You have, of course, both the specific and the general when you talk about such things. First of all, you have the specific value of a locality in its production of materials that the world needs, like rubber and ti...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Why did the US send combat troops to Vietnam after the Gulf of Tonkin incident?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did the military collapse of the ARVN in 1963–64 convince US leaders that direct intervention was unavoida...

- Saigon military instability
- Chronic ARVN desertions
- Vietcong rural expansion

2 • What occurred during the August 1964 Gulf of Tonkin incident, and how did Johnson use it politically?

- USS Maddox patrol
- Gulf of Tonkin incident
- Disputed second torpedo attack

3 • Why was the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution described by critics as a 'blank check' for presidential war-making?

- Gulf of Tonkin Resolution
- Congress 'blank check'
- Presidential war powers

4 • What were the strategic objectives of Operation Rolling Thunder, and why did it fail to halt northern infiltration?

- Vietcong raid on Pleiku
- Eight US soldiers killed
- Operation Rolling Thunder launched

5 • How did the landing of 3,500 Marines at Da Nang in March 1965 mark the permanent Americanization of the wa...

- Da Nang beach landing
- 3,500 US Marines arrive
- General Westmoreland escalation

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why US military involvement in Vietnam escalated under President Johnson between 1964 and 1965. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The Gulf of Tonkin incident (August 1964) • The attack on the US base at Pleiku (February 1965) ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on Page 9)*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.2). In the drawing box, sketch the destroyer USS Maddox in the Gulf of Tonkin alongside US Marines splashing ashore on Red Beach Two at Da Nang. [ ] Done

QUESTION 2 CONTINUATION: QUESTION 2 *(Conclude your causal analysis with sustained historical links)*

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the deployment of US Marines to Vietnam in March 1965. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Commander, Task Group 72.1 (USS Maddox) to Commander Seventh Fleet, Flash Precedence Cable (4 August 1964)*

Review of action makes many reported contacts and torpedoes fired appear doubtful. Freak weather effects on radar and overeager sonarmen may have accounted for many reports. No actual visual sightings by Maddox. Sug...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Why did US military tactics (like bombing and search & destroy) fail to defeat the Vietcong?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did the Vietcong tactic of 'hanging onto the belts' neutralize superior American firepower and technology?

- General Vo Nguyen Giap strategy
- 'Hanging on US belt buckles'
- Vanishing into peasant villages

2 • Why did the Cu Chi tunnel complex and deadly booby traps severely undermine American military morale?

- Cu Chi 250km tunnel networks
- Punji sticks & booby traps
- Subterranean supply rooms

3 • How did the Ho Chi Minh Trail enable North Vietnam to sustain the southern insurgency despite continuous US...

- Ho Chi Minh Trail network
- Laos & Cambodia border routes
- Soviet & Chinese arms pipeline

4 • Why did the use of chemical defoliants like Agent Orange and napalm prove counterproductive for US military ...

- Operation Ranch Hand
- Agent Orange chemical defoliant
- Napalm burning jelly

5 • How did Search and Destroy operations fail to distinguish between civilian peasants and Vietcong fighters?

- Helicopter air mobility
- 'Zippo' village burns
- Body-count measurement failure

"Tonkin Gulf Resolution: Congress granted President Johnson a blank cheque to take 'all necessary measures' in Vietnam."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong between 1965 and 1968. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- Vietcong guerrilla tactics and underground tunnel networks
- US Search and Destroy missions and chemical defoliants (Agent Orange)

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 12)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.3). In the drawing box, sketch a "Huey" helicopter over dense jungle canopy alongside an intricate underground Vietcong tunnel entrance. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the role of helicopters in US combat operations in Vietnam. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *MACV Combined Intelligence Center, Exploitation of Enemy Facilities Section*

Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

What was Nixon's 'Vietnamization' policy, and did it achieve peace with honour?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did the 1968 Tet Offensive shatter American government claims that the war in Vietnam was nearly won?

- Tet Offensive surprise assault
- US Embassy Saigon breached
- Military defeat for Vietcong

2 • How did Walter Cronkite's television broadcast deepen the public 'credibility gap' regarding the Vietnam War?

- Walter Cronkite CBS broadcast
- 'Mired in stalemate'
- Widening credibility gap

3 • Why did the political fallout from the Tet Offensive force President Johnson to withdraw from the 1968 preside...

- LBJ television address
- Bombing halt north 20th
- Withdrawal from 1968 election

4 • What were the core goals and contradictions of President Nixon's policy of 'Vietnamization'?

- Richard Nixon election
- Vietnamization doctrine
- ARVN army expansion

5 • How did phased troop withdrawals under Vietnamization affect the discipline and morale of remaining US forc...

- Phased US troop withdrawals
- GI morale crisis & 'fragging'
- Substance abuse in ranks

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Tet Offensive of January 1968 was a decisive turning point in the Vietnam War. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- The military outcome for the Vietcong and US forces
- The 'credibility gap' and Walter Cronkite's television report

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 15)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 3.4). In the drawing box, sketch television news cameras broadcasting the Tet Offensive battle inside the US Embassy courtyard in Saigon. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about President Nixon's visit to US soldiers in Vietnam in 1969. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Walter Cronkite, CBS News Special Report: Report from Vietnam (27 February 1968)*

To say that we are closer to victory today is to believe, in the face of the evidence, the optimists who have been wrong in the past. To suggest we are on the edge of defeat is to yield to unreasonable pessimism. To...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the reasons why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong (1965–68)?

Target: AO3 [8 marks]: Analyse sources on Content, Contextual Knowledge, and Provenance (Nature, Origin, Purpose).

SOURCE B — Primary Evidence

"We were sent on 'search and destroy' patrols through dense jungle and steaming swamps. The strategy was simple: find the enemy, fix him, and destroy him with massive artillery and air strikes. But we could almost never locate him. The Vietcong fought on their own terms: a sudden burst of fire from concealed tree lines, a sniper round, or an explosive booby trap made from a recycled artillery shell and bamboo punji sticks. When we entered a village, we could not distinguish a friendly farmer by day from a guerrilla fighter by night. Frustrated soldiers burned thatched huts with Zippo lighters, turning the very peasants we were sent to defend into sworn enemies."

Provenance: Written by Philip Caputo, a US Marine lieutenant who commanded combat infantry units in South Vietnam in 1965–66.

SOURCE C — Primary Evidence

"The Americans possessed immense firepower—jets, helicopters, tanks, and chemical poisons that destroyed our rice crops. But they did not know the forest, and they did not know our people. Beneath the soil, we built over two hundred kilometers of multi-level tunnels with barracks, hospitals, and weapons factories. When their planes bombed, we remained safe twenty feet underground. When their infantry advanced, our booby traps—punji stakes smeared with animal dung, tripwires, and toe-poppers—inflicted daily casualties and wrecked their nerves. We were fighting for our own homeland; their soldiers fought only because they were drafted."

Provenance: Oral history interview with a veteran Vietcong combatant who operated in the Cu Chi tunnel network throughout the war.

SOURCE B UTILITY (CONTENT & COP): EYEWITNESS COMBAT OFFICER DETAILING TACTICAL FAILURES: INABILITY TO FIND THE ENEMY, BOOBY TRAPS, BURNING VILLAGES (ZIPPO RAIDS), AND LOSING THE "HEARTS AND MINDS" OF PEASANTS. *(Analyse Content, Historical Context & Provenance NOP)*

"Ho Chi Minh Trail: A 16,000km logistical highway through Laos and Cambodia supplying 60 tons of supplies daily to the South."

SOURCE C UTILITY (CONTENT & COP): PRIMARY GUERRILLA PERSPECTIVE SHOWING WHY VIETCONG TACTICS SUCCEEDED: CU CHI TUNNELS NEUTRALIZING AIR POWER, PSYCHOLOGICAL IMPACT OF BOOBY TRAPS, AND HIGH MORALE. **Score: [/ 8]**

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 & 2

Study Interpretations 1 and 2 below for Questions 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)

INTERPRETATION 1

"American military tactics were fundamentally mismatched with the political realities of guerrilla warfare in Vietnam. General Westmoreland's strategy of 'search and destroy' relied on attrition—measuring progress through enemy 'body counts' rather than securing territory. Because US troops were dropped into hostile territory by helicopter and evacuated immediately after contact, they never established permanent security for South Vietnamese villagers. Furthermore, the massive reliance on indiscriminate firepower—napalm, defoliants (Agent Orange), and artillery—inflicted horrific civilian casualties, alienating the rural population and pushing thousands of previously neutral peasants into active support for the National Liberation Front."

Historian Christian G. Appy, 'Working-Class War: American Combat Soldiers and Vietnam' (1993)

INTERPRETATION 2

"The failure of the American military effort was not primarily due to flawed US tactics, but to the extraordinary effectiveness, discipline, and strategic design of the communist insurgency. The Vietcong and North Vietnamese Army operated an exceptionally sophisticated underground logistics infrastructure. Their vast network of subterranean tunnels in Cu Chi and the Iron Triangle neutralized American air superiority. Moreover, the Vietcong enforced strict discipline, utilized terror ruthlessly to eliminate uncooperative village leaders, and benefited from an inexhaustible flow of Soviet and Chinese weapons down the Ho Chi Minh Trail. The tenacity and survival techniques of the communist cadres made them impervious to military defeat."

Historian Guenter Lewy, 'America in Vietnam' (1978)

Question 3(b): Main Difference in Views [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations.

Formula: Interpretation 1 argues that US failure was caused by flawed American military strategy—specifically the reliance on attrition, search-and-destroy, and indiscriminate firepower that alienated the peasant population. In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues that US failure was primarily due to the superior resilience, subterranean tunnel networks, and effective guerrilla discipline of the Vietcong.

Question 3(c): Reason Why Interpretations Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

Examiner Guidance: The historians give different views because they have utilized different perspectives in their research. The author of Interpretation 1 has focused on American combat reports and soldier accounts like Source B, emphasizing how search-and-destroy alienated Vietnamese villagers. In contrast, the author of Interpretation 2 has examined communist operational records and guerrilla testimonies like Source C, highlighting the subterranean engineering of the Cu Chi tunnels and guerrilla resilience.

QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong (1965–68)?

Thesis Prompt: Establish your judgment criteria, select quotes from Interpretations 1 & 2, and deploy contextual historical knowledge.

Criteria Planning Canvas: Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict: *(Essay continues on Page 19)*

Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks): Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment. **SPaG: 4/4 MARKS**

Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

AO4: [/ 16] | SPaG: [/ 4] | Total: [/ 20]

[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the reasons why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong (1965–68)?

Write your response in the space provided below:

Band 4 Criteria Check:	[ ] Criteria Established	[ ] Both Ints Explored	[ ] Precise Own Knowledge	[ ] Justified Verdict	**Teacher Sign-off:** _____

"Walter Cronkite (Feb 1968): The CBS anchor told millions of viewers that the bloody war in Vietnam was mired in an unwinnable stalemate." **19/20**

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 3 TRACKER

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–1975 (US Involvement in the Vietnam War, 1954–68)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 INFER (4M)	Q2 EXPLAIN (12M)	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT3.1: Why did the US support the unpopular government of Ngo Dinh Diem in South Vietnam?** *"Why did the US support the unpopular government of Ngo Dinh Diem in South Vietnam?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
2	**KT3.2: Why did the US send combat troops to Vietnam after the Gulf of Tonkin incident?** *"Why did the US send combat troops to Vietnam after the Gulf of Tonkin incident?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
3	**KT3.3: Why did US military tactics (like bombing and search & destroy) fail to defeat the Vietcong?** *"Why did US military tactics (like bombing and search & destroy) fail to defeat the Vietcong?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
4	**KT3.4: What was Nixon's 'Vietnamization' policy, and did it achieve peace with honour?** *"What was Nixon's 'Vietnamization' policy, and did it achieve peace with honour?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
★	**Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)** *Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]*	Q3(a): / 8	Q3(b): / 4	Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20	/ 36
KEY TOPIC 3 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1 Infer: / 16**	**Q2 Cause: / 48**	**/ 140**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • 20-QUESTION PRACTICE QUIZZES

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes

KT 3.1	KT 3.2	KT 3.3	KT 3.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**

"LBJ Steps Aside (March 1968): Plunging approval ratings forced Johnson to announce he would not seek re-election as president."

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 4 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1968–1975

Key Topic 4: The Escalation and Ending of the Conflict in Vietnam, 1968–75

Vietnamization, Domestic Opposition, Paris Peace Accords & The Fall of Saigon



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • 4 MAY 1970

National Guardsmen Facing Student Protesters at Kent State, 4 May 1970

Ohio National Guardsmen deploy on the university commons with rifles during anti-war demonstrations against the secret invasion of Cambodia, moments before four students were fatally shot.

PEARSON EDEXCEL OPTION 33 • KEY TOPIC 4 CONTENT OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

1 Opposition to the War

- Reasons for the growth of opposition, including the student movement, TV and media coverage of the war and the draft system.
- Public reaction to the My Lai Massacre (1968). The trial of Lt. Calley.
- The Kent State University shootings (1970).

2 Support for the War

- Reasons for support for the war, including the fear of communism.
- The 'hard hats' and the 'silent majority'.

3 The Peace Process and End of the War

- Reasons for, and key features of, the peace negotiations (1972–73).
- The significance of the **Paris Peace Agreement (1973)**.
- The economic and human costs of the war for the USA.

4 Reasons for the Failure of the Usa in Vietnam

- The strengths of North Vietnam, including the significance of Russian and Chinese support, Vietcong tactics and the Ho Chi Minh Trail.
- The weaknesses of the US armed forces. The failure of US tactics.
- The impact of opposition to the war in the USA.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 4)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

12 November 1969 • My Lai Massacre Exposed to the Public

MORAL CRISIS

Journalist Seymour Hersh reveals that US soldiers murdered over 500 unarmed Vietnamese civilians in the hamlet of Son My in March 1968, sparking nationwide revulsion.

3 November 1969 • Nixon's "Silent Majority" Address

DOMESTIC POLARIZATION

President Nixon appeals to conservative, patriotic Americans to support his Vietnamization policy against the demands of vocal campus anti-war protesters.

30 April 1970 • US Incursion into Cambodia Announced

EXPANSION OF WAR

Nixon announces the secret invasion of neutral Cambodia to destroy communist sanctuaries along the Ho Chi Minh Trail, sparking riots across hundreds of college campuses.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 4)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

4 May 1970 • Kent State University Shootings

DOMESTIC TRAGEDY

Ohio National Guardsmen fire 67 rounds into unarmed student demonstrators protesting the Cambodian invasion, killing four students and triggering a nationwide student strike of four million.

27 January 1973 • Paris Peace Accords Signed

AMERICAN EXIT

The United States, North Vietnam, South Vietnam, and the PRG sign the ceasefire agreement in Paris, securing the complete withdrawal of all US military personnel and POW releases.

30 April 1975 • Fall of Saigon to Communist Forces

COMMUNIST VICTORY

North Vietnamese tanks smash through the gates of the Presidential Palace in Saigon. The remaining Americans are evacuated by helicopter from the embassy rooftop; Vietnam is reunited.

Why did so many Americans oppose the Vietnam War (like at My Lai and Kent State)?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • How did uncensored nightly television coverage turn American domestic public opinion against the Vietnam Wa...

- First 'living room war'
- Uncensored colour news footage
- Nightly body count reports

2 • Why did class and racial inequalities in the military draft provoke widespread campus resistance and draft car...

- Selective Service draft lottery
- College deferment bias
- Draft card public burning

3 • How did revelations of the My Lai massacre undermine the moral justification for the American war effort?

- My Lai massacre (March 1968)
- Lieutenant William Calley
- 500 civilian deaths exposed

4 • Why did the shooting of student protesters at Kent State University in May 1970 cause nationwide campus uphe...

- Cambodian incursion protests
- Kent State shootings (1970)
- Four students killed

5 • How did the publication of the Pentagon Papers permanently damage public trust in presidential honesty?

- Daniel Ellsberg whistleblower
- New York Times publication
- Government deceit revealed

"My Lai Massacre (March 1968): Charlie Company murdered over 500 unarmed Vietnamese civilians; exposed to the public in late 1969."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why public opposition to the Vietnam War intensified in the United States between 1968 and 1971. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- Revelations of the My Lai massacre (November 1969)
- The Kent State University shootings (May 1970)

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 6)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 4.1). In the drawing box, sketch the peace sign and a draft-card burning on a college campus alongside the Kent State memorial. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the introduction of the military draft lottery in 1969. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Peers Commission Inquiry into the My Lai Massacre, Department of the Army (1970)*
Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Why did some Americans support the Vietnam War and the 'Silent Majority'?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did millions of patriotic Americans continue to view the Vietnam War as an essential Cold War struggle?

- Cold War anti-communist consensus
- Support for US troops
- Fear of global surrender

2 • How did President Nixon's 'Silent Majority' speech mobilize conservative support for his administration's war p...

- 'Silent Majority' speech (1969)
- Appeal to conservative voters
- Counter-protest mobilization

3 • What did the May 1970 'Hard Hat Riots' in Manhattan reveal about working-class hostility toward student anti-...

- Wall Street construction workers
- 'Hard Hat Riots' (1970)
- Assault on student protesters

4 • Why did congressional hawks argue that immediate American withdrawal would catastrophically damage US g...

- Congressional hawk faction
- Defending American honor
- Commitment to SEATO allies

5 • How did Nixon's massive 1972 electoral victory prove the enduring strength of the conservative 'Silent Majority'?

- 1972 Presidential Election
- 49-state Nixon landslide
- Defeat of anti-war McGovern

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why President Richard Nixon introduced the policy of 'Vietnamization' in 1969. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • Domestic anti-war protests and the 'Silent Majority' • The aim of achieving 'peace with honour' ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 9)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 4.2). In the drawing box, sketch President Nixon delivering his "Silent Majority" speech flanked by construction workers waving American flags. [ ] Done

"Kent State Shootings (4 May 1970): Ohio National Guardsmen fired 67 rounds into unarmed student protesters, killing four."

QUESTION 2 CONTINUATION: QUESTION 2 *(Conclude your causal analysis with sustained historical links)*

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about President Nixon's televised 'Silent Majority' address (November 1969). [4 marks]

SOURCE A *President Richard Nixon, Address to the Nation on the War in Vietnam (3 November 1969)*

Let historians not record that when America was the most powerful nation in the world we passed on the other side of the road and allowed the last hopes for peace and freedom of millions of people to be suffocated b...

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

How did the US exit Vietnam, and why did South Vietnam fall so quickly in 1975?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why was Henry Kissinger's concession allowing North Vietnamese troops to remain in South Vietnam so contro...

- Henry Kissinger & Le Duc Tho
- Secret Paris peace talks
- PAVN troops permitted South

2 • What did Nixon intend to achieve by unleashing the massive Operation Linebacker II 'Christmas Bombings' in ...

- Operation Linebacker II
- B-52 'Christmas Bombings'
- Hanoi & Haiphong battered

3 • What were the primary terms of the 1973 Paris Peace Accords, and how did they favor North Vietnam strategical...

- 1973 Paris Peace Accords
- Complete US military withdrawal
- American POWs repatriated

4 • How did the final departure of US combat troops in March 1973 leave South Vietnam militarily vulnerable?

- Final US combat troops depart
- Military Assistance Command closes
- ARVN left vulnerable

5 • Why was the 1973 War Powers Act passed by Congress, and how did it prevent future US military intervention?

- 1973 War Powers Act
- Nixon veto overridden
- Presidential 60-day limit

"Pentagon Papers (1971): Leaked top-secret DoD documents revealed four successive presidents had lied to Congress about Vietnam."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Paris Peace Accords were signed in January 1973. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- The 'Christmas Bombings' (Operation Linebacker II, December 1972)
- The diplomatic rapprochement between the US, China, and the Soviet Union

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 12)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 4.3). In the drawing box, sketch the signing table at the Paris Peace Accords alongside American POWs stepping off the plane at Operation Homecoming. [ ] Done

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the signing of the Paris Peace Accords in January 1973. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *Associated Press Wirephoto / United States Department of State Archives*

Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

What were the main reasons why the US failed to win the war in Vietnam?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 • Why did the South Vietnamese military collapse so rapidly during the communist Spring Offensive of 1975?

- 1975 Spring Offensive
- Central Highlands collapse
- ARVN panic & retreat

2 • How did the frantic helicopter evacuations and the fall of Saigon on 30 April 1975 symbolize total American defe...

- Operation Frequent Wind
- Helicopter embassy evacuations
- Fall of Saigon (30 April)

3 • Why was the ideological commitment of Vietnamese communists superior to the fragile political legitimacy of S...

- Vietnamese nationalist resolve
- Saigon government corruption
- Asymmetric political will

4 • Why were advanced American military technology and firepower unable to overcome asymmetric jungle guerri...

- Inappropriate conventional firepower
- Hearts and minds alienated
- Jungle terrain resilience

5 • How did the loss of American domestic political will ultimately decide the outcome of the Vietnam War?

- Loss of domestic support
- Watergate political paralysis
- Congress cuts military aid

"Paris Peace Accords (Jan 1973): Ceasefire signed; complete withdrawal of all US combat personnel; return of American POWs."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 3

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why South Vietnam collapsed so rapidly in 1975 following the withdrawal of US forces. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer:
- The corruption and military weaknesses of the ARVN
- US congressional cuts to military and economic aid

(You must also use information of your own.)

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One decisive reason was that... • For example, this meant that... • This directly triggered... • Therefore, this was critical because... • On the other hand, another factor was... • Consequently, the ultimate result was...*

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on Page 15)

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Key Topic 4.4). In the drawing box, sketch an overloaded Huey helicopter evacuating personnel from the US Embassy rooftop during the Fall of Saigon. [ ] Done

"War Powers Act (1973): Congress passed legislation restricting presidential authority to commit US military forces overseas."

QUESTION 2 CONTINUATION: QUESTION 2 *(Conclude your causal analysis with sustained historical links)*

QUESTION 1 PRACTICE **INFERENCE FROM SOURCE A** **4 MARKS • 5 MINS** **Score: [/ 4]**

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the physical and psychological toll on US combat soldiers in Vietnam. [4 marks]

SOURCE A *National Archives Still Pictures, Record Group 111, Washington D.C.*
Contemporary archival extract.

(i) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

(ii) What I can infer: *[1 mark]*

Details in SOURCE A that tell me this: *[1 mark]*

Question 3(a): Source Utility [8 marks • 12 mins]

Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War in the USA (1968–71)?

Target: AO3 [8 marks]: Analyse sources on Content, Contextual Knowledge, and Provenance (Nature, Origin, Purpose).

SOURCE B — Primary Evidence

"It seems now more certain than ever that the bloody experience of Vietnam is to end in a stalemate. To say that we are closer to victory today is to believe, in the face of the evidence, the optimists who have been wrong in the past. To suggest we are on the edge of defeat is to yield to unreasonable despair. To say that we are mired in stalemate seems the only realistic, yet unsatisfactory, conclusion. It is increasingly clear to this reporter that the only rational way out will be to negotiate, not as victors, but as an honorable people who lived up to their pledge to defend democracy and did the best they could."

Provenance: Broadcast to millions of American households by the nation's most respected news anchor following his fact-finding mission to Vietnam after the Tet Offensive.

SOURCE C — Primary Evidence

"Rich young men with political connections go to prestigious colleges and receive student deferments. Working-class and Black youth who cannot afford university are handed M16 rifles and shipped off to die in the jungles for a corrupt dictatorship in Saigon. Over 35,000 American boys have already come home in aluminum coffins, while Washington politicians lie about 'progress'. We refuse to participate in the slaughter of Vietnamese peasants. Burn your draft cards! Join the nationwide Moratorium on October 15! Strike against the war machine!"

Provenance: Protest pamphlet produced and circulated by the student anti-war organization Students for a Democratic Society (SDS) prior to the October 1969 Moratorium.

SOURCE B UTILITY (CONTENT & COP): ILLUSTRATES THE IMMENSE INFLUENCE OF TELEVISED NEWS JOURNALISM; CRONKITE DECLARING THE WAR A STALEMATE DESTROYED THE "CREDIBILITY GAP" AND SWAYED MIDDLE-CLASS OPINION. *(Analyse Content, Historical Context & Provenance NOP)*

SOURCE C UTILITY (CONTENT & COP): ILLUSTRATES THE ANGER OVER THE MILITARY DRAFT SYSTEM, CLASS INEQUALITIES (DEFERMENTS FOR RICH STUDENTS), RISING BODY BAGS, AND THE DIRECT ACTION TACTICS OF STUDENT GROUPS LIKE SDS. **Score: [/ 8]**

HISTORICAL INTERPRETATIONS 1 & 2

Study Interpretations 1 and 2 below for Questions 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)

INTERPRETATION 1

"The fundamental engine driving mass opposition to the war was television journalism and the uncensored visual exposure of combat horrors. Vietnam was America's first 'living-room war'. Night after night, millions of ordinary Americans watched unedited color footage of wounded soldiers, burning huts, civilian body counts, and napalmed children alongside their evening dinners. When trusted national figures like Walter Cronkite declared the war unwinnable after the Tet Offensive, it shattered the government's credibility. The media's subsequent exposure of atrocities like the My Lai massacre in 1969 made it impossible for the moral conscience of middle America to support the war any longer."

Historian Chester Pach, 'The Real Media War on Vietnam' (1996)

INTERPRETATION 2

"While television coverage was vivid, the primary catalyst for mass domestic opposition was the personal, immediate threat posed by the military draft system combined with skyrocketing American casualties. Young men faced the terrifying prospect of conscription into an ambiguous conflict, producing a massive student rebellion across college campuses. Student organizations like SDS, energized by civil rights techniques, transformed anti-war sentiment into sustained street mobilization, draft-card burnings, and nationwide moratoriums involving millions of demonstrators. It was the visceral fear of the draft, coupled with the rising toll of over 50,000 American deaths, that galvanized grassroots resistance and made the war politically unsustainable."

Historian Melvin Small, 'Antiwarriors: The Vietnam War and the Battle for America's Hearts and Minds' (2002)

Question 3(b): Main Difference in Views [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations.

Formula: Interpretation 1 argues that anti-war opposition was primarily generated by uncensored television media coverage and news anchors like Walter Cronkite exposing combat horrors and atrocities (My Lai), whereas Interpretation 2 argues that opposition was driven primarily by the personal threat of the military draft, rising casualties, and campus student protests.

Question 3(c): Reason Why Interpretations Differ [4 marks • 5 mins]

Score: [/ 4]

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

Examiner Guidance: The historians hold different views because they have examined different sources of evidence. The author of Interpretation 1 has focused on television broadcast history and media journalism such as Source B, showing how Cronkite's commentary swayed middle America. In contrast, the author of Interpretation 2 has focused on youth resistance records and protest flyers such as Source C, emphasizing the direct fear of the draft, casualty rates, and student activism on university campuses.

QUESTION 3(D) ESSAY PLANNING & CRITERIA SETUP

16 Marks + 4 SPaG = 20 Marks • 25 Mins

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War in the USA (1968–71)?

Thesis Prompt: Establish your judgment criteria, select quotes from Interpretations 1 & 2, and deploy contextual historical knowledge.

Criteria Planning Canvas: Establish criteria benchmark, map quotes from Int 1 & Int 2, and outline your verdict: *(Essay continues on Page 19)*

Level 4 Target (13–16 Marks): Balanced analysis of both views • Sustained contextual knowledge • Justified criteria-led judgment. **SPaG: 4/4 MARKS**

"Human & Financial Toll: Over 58,000 American soldiers dead; over 2 million Vietnamese dead; $168 billion spent."

Question 3(d): Evaluative Essay on Historical Interpretations

AO4: [/ 16] | SPaG: [/ 4] | Total: [/ 20]

[16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 20 MARKS • TIMED ESSAY: 25 MINS]

How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War in the USA (1968–71)?

Write your response in the space provided below:

Band 4 Criteria Check:	[ ] Criteria Established	[ ] Both Ints Explored	[ ] Precise Own Knowledge	[ ] Justified Verdict	**Teacher Sign-off:** _____

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 4 TRACKER

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–1975 (The Escalation and Ending of the Conflict in Vietnam, 1968–75)

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / ASSESSMENT UNIT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1 INFER (4M)	Q2 EXPLAIN (12M)	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT4.1: Why did so many Americans oppose the Vietnam War (like at My Lai and Kent State)?** *"Why did so many Americans oppose the Vietnam War (like at My Lai and Kent State)?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
2	**KT4.2: Why did some Americans support the Vietnam War and the 'Silent Majority'?** *"Why did some Americans support the Vietnam War and the 'Silent Majority'?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
3	**KT4.3: How did the US exit Vietnam, and why did South Vietnam fall so quickly in 1975?** *"How did the US exit Vietnam, and why did South Vietnam fall so quickly in 1975?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
4	**KT4.4: What were the main reasons why the US failed to win the war in Vietnam?** *"What were the main reasons why the US failed to win the war in Vietnam?"*	/ 10	/ 4	/ 12	/ 26
★	**Section B Capstone Assessment (pp. 16–19)** *Q3(a) Utility [8m] • Q3(b) Study Views [4m] • Q3(c) Why Differ [4m] • Q3(d) Evaluative Essay [20m]*	Q3(a): / 8	Q3(b): / 4	Q3(c): / 4 • Q3(d): / 20	/ 36
KEY TOPIC 4 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1 Infer: / 16**	**Q2 Cause: / 48**	**/ 140**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • 20-QUESTION PRACTICE QUIZZES

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes

KT 4.1	KT 4.2	KT 4.3	KT 4.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**

"Question 3(c): Historians evaluate differing evidence pools: uncensored broadcast journalism vs anti-war SDS activism."